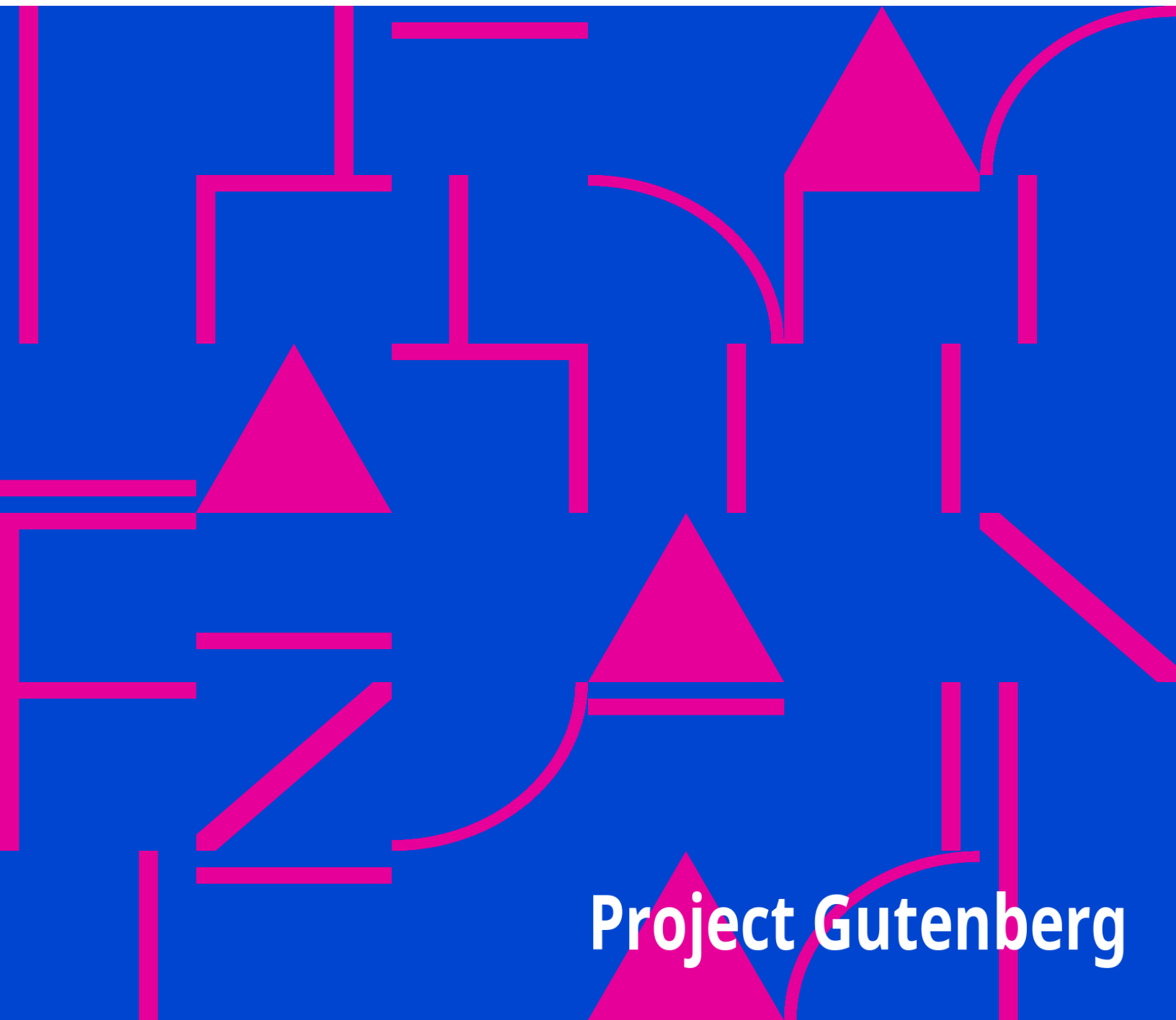


The Autobiography of a Monkey

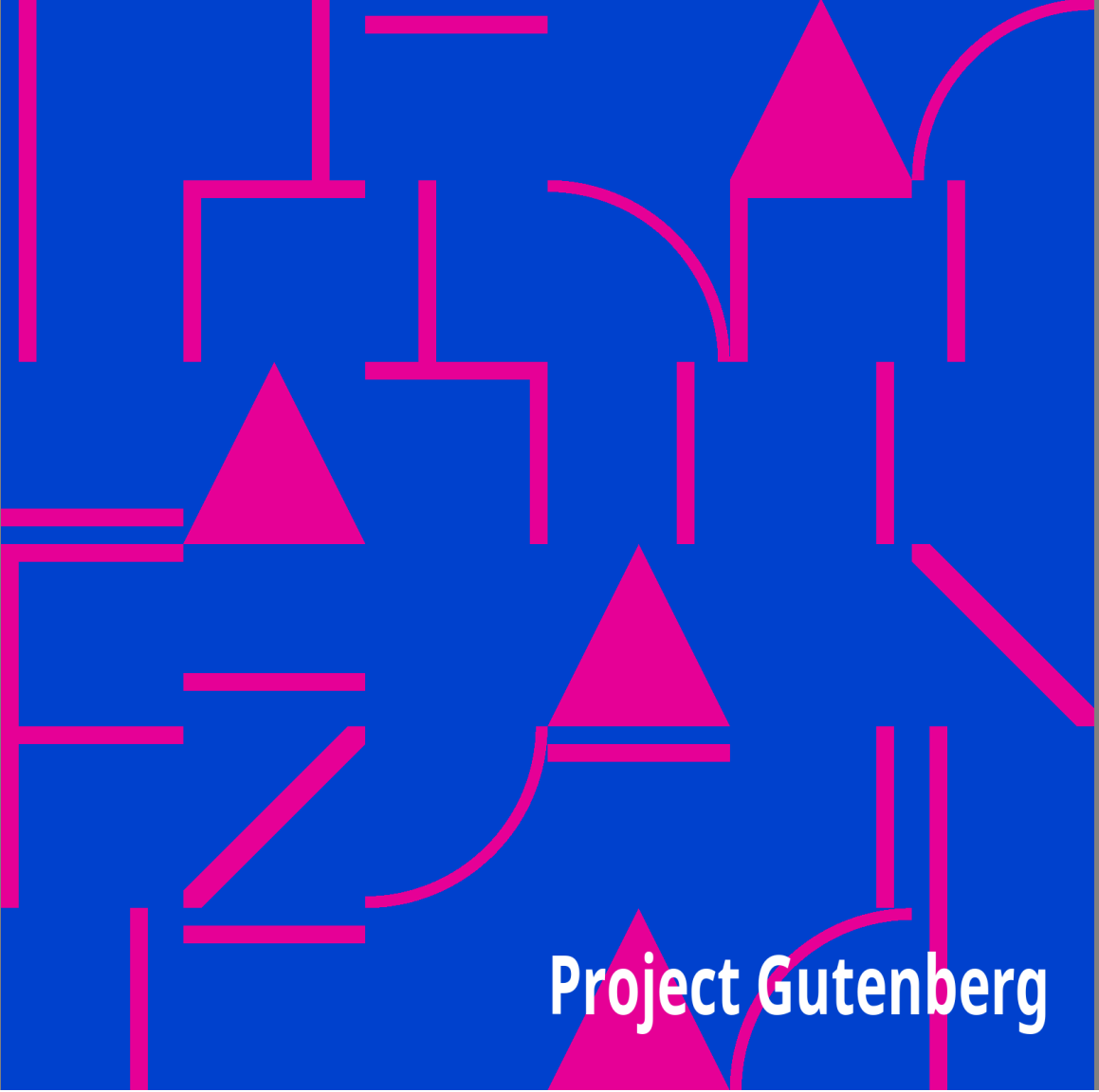
Albert Bigelow Paine

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The Autobiography of a Monkey

Albert Bigelow Paine

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Title: The Autobiography of a Monkey

Author: Albert Bigelow Paine

Illustrator: Henry Mayer

Release date: September 4, 2010 [eBook #33629]

Most recently updated: January 6, 2021

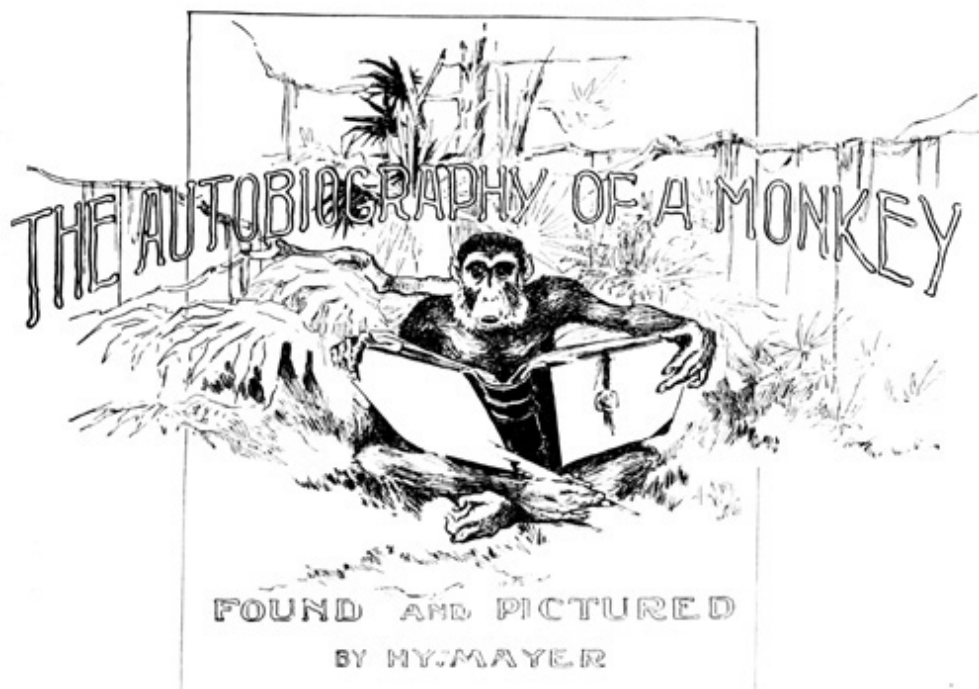
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE
AUTOBIOGRAPHY OF A MONKEY ***

THE AUTOBIOGRAPHY OF A MONKEY



**FOUND AND PICTURED
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VERSES BY ALBERT BIGELOW PAINE



NEW YORK R. H. RUSSELL

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PART FIRST.

THE DEPARTURE FROM THE FOREST.

Where the light laughs in through the tree-tops

And sports with the tangled glade,
In the depths of an Afric forest
My earliest scenes were laid.



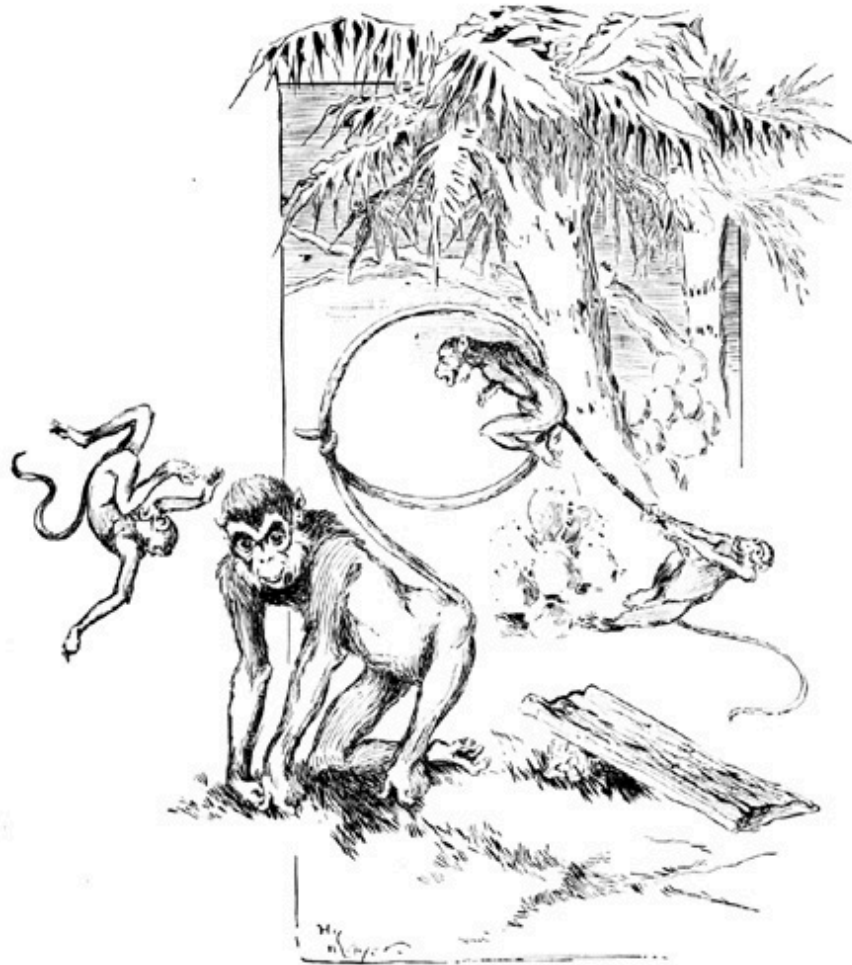
In a bower that was merry with smilax
From the grimace of no-where, I
woke
I was born on the first day of April
And they called me a jungle joke.



And the voices of birds were about
me—

And the beat and the flutter
of wing;

While morning returned at the
trumpet
Of Tusky, our elephant
king.

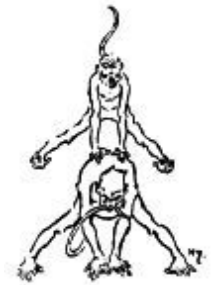


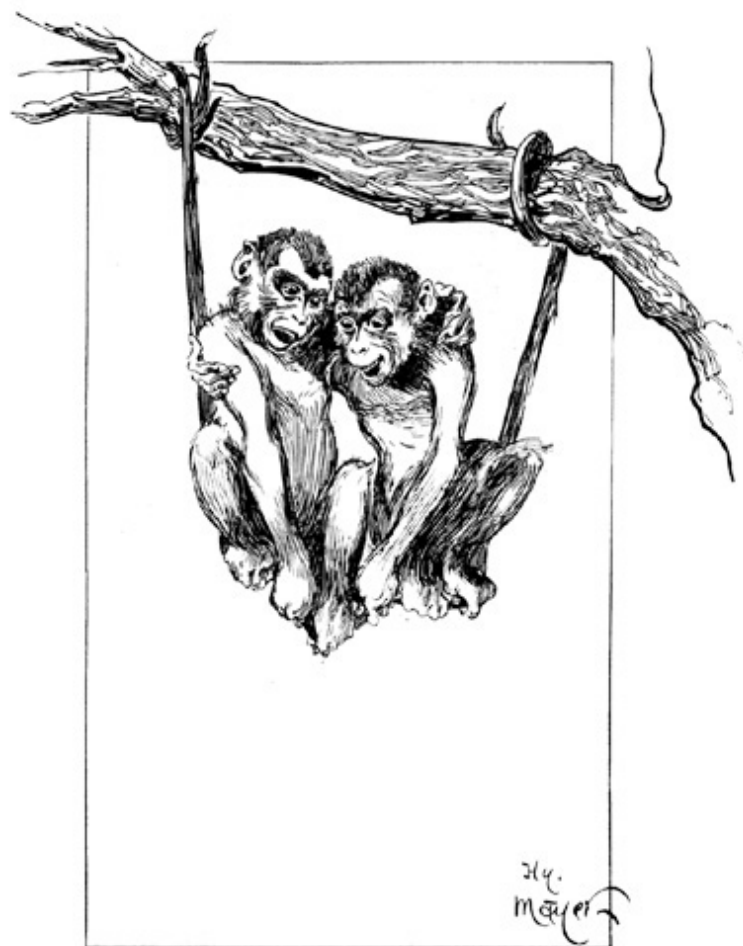


My nurse was a crooning old beldame
Who gazed in the palms of my hands
And vowed I was destined to travel
In many and marvellous lands.



But little I heeded her croaking,
For I gamboled the whole
day long,
And swung by my tail from the
tree-top,
Or joined in the jungle
song.





THE SONG OF THE JUNGLE.

The Elephant:

Oh, I am the lord of the forest and plain!

The Lion, Tigers, etc.:

And we are the beasts that acknowledge
your reign!

The Birds:

And we are the minstrels that come at your
call!

The Monkeys:

And we are the jesters that laugh at you all!



Chorus, All—

Oh, yes! Oh, yes! Oh, yes! Oh, yes!

*The tribes of the jungle are we—
Our home is the darksome wilderness
That never a man shall see.*

The Elephant:

Oh, the jungle was meant and was made for
my will!

The Lions, Tigers, etc.:

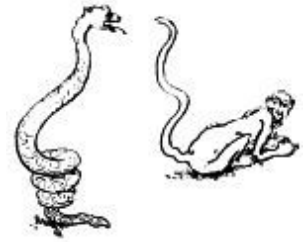
For the sport of the chase and the zest of the
kill!

The Birds:

For the beating of wings and the echo of
song!

The Monkeys:

For gambol and grimace the whole season
long!



Chorus, All:
Hurrah! Hurrah! Hurrah! Oh,
yes!
For all of the tribes that be
With homes in the tangled
wilderness
That never a man shall see.



But, alas, for the boasts of the jungle!
The men came among us one
day,
And one with a box that made music
Enticed foolish monkeys away.

The birds and the beasts of the forest
Were mute at the marvellous song,
But the monkeys crept out of the tree-tops
—
An eager and wondering throng.



he birds and the beasts of the forest
Kept hidden and silent that day,
But the monkey-folk formed a
procession
And followed the minstrel away.

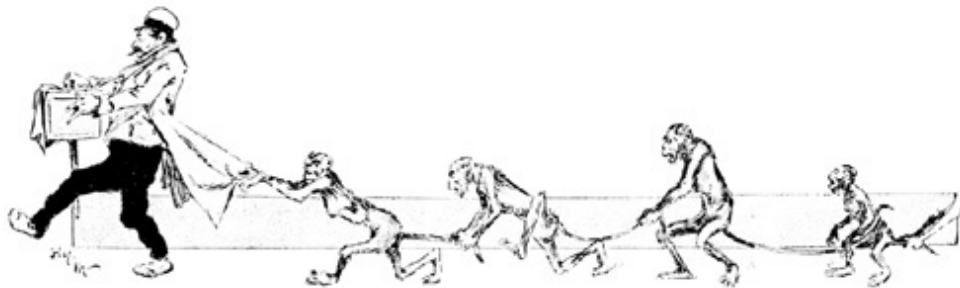
nd thus did we give up the forest

T A

To dwell with our
brothers, the men

Farewell to the
beautiful jungle!

'Twas long ere I
saw it again!





PART SECOND.

THE WAYS OF MEN.

Then away to a far distant country
On a drift that they said was
a ship,
And I studied the ways of my
master
And profited much by the
trip.

And we sailed to his home in fair Naples,
Where I studied the language of
men,
And I sat on a bench with his children,
But soon we went sailing again.





nd I made some nice friends on the voyage,
And engaged in a pretty
romance.

I charmed all the ladies by climbing,
And one of them taught me to
dance.

A

Yet often I longed
for the jungle—
Its song and
the rustle of
wing—
And sometimes
at night in my
slumber

I talked with our elephant
king.





One morning my master awoke me,
And, dressed in a gaudy new suit,
I beheld the New World in the sunlight,
And lifted my hat in salute.

And then began troubles and trials—
Through the streets by a string I
was led;

Toiling hard all the day for my master,
Yet oft going hungry to bed.



But he sold me at last to a circus
And my lot became easier then,
So I gave many moments of leisure
To acquiring the habits of men.

I copied their manners and customs
I made of each fashion a note;
And the children admired my performance
And the ladies the cut of my coat.





By and by I was sold to a banker
Who was charmed with my
ball-rolling feat,
And arrayed in a Fauntleroy
costume
I passed all my time on the
street.

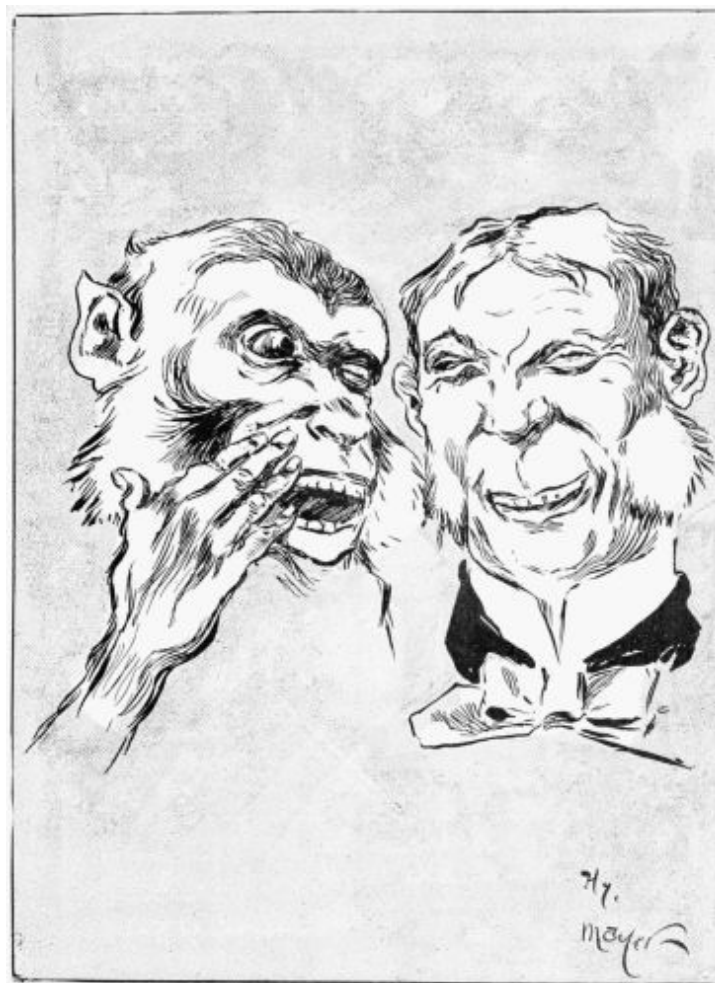
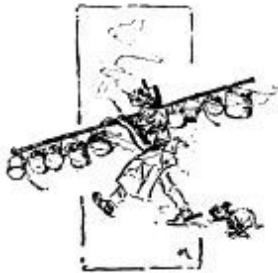




But alas for my plans of the future!
He died without leaving a cent,
And I had to go out to hard labor
To pay for my victuals and rent;

Till I met with a gentleman's valet
Who was like me in manner and
face,
And I told him some stories that
pleased him

And bribed him to give me his place.





Then I started to serve my new master—
A bachelor cynic was he,
Who quickly saw through the
deception
And made a proposal to me.

Said he: "You're a monkey, you
rascal,
And an excellent type of the
brood;
Let's play a good joke on society
By passing you off as a
dude."





So he took me at first to his barber,
Who shaved me and shortened my
hair,
And the last tangled trace of the jungle
Was gone when I rose from his chair.



And then to his tailor and hatter—
His hosier and all of the rest,
Till at night I was changed from a
monkey

To a chappie most stylishly
dressed.

And standing alone and reflecting
I thought of the why and the how,
And I wondered what Tusky was doing
And what would the jungle say, now.





PART THIRD.

THE BUTTERFLY WHIRL.

It was then for the triumphs of conquest!
Oh, then for the life of the swell!
I dwelt like a lord with my patron
In a suite of a gilded hotel.

And we went out to plays and to dinners—
On the ladies he took me to call—
And once we received invitations
To a beautiful fancy-dress ball.



'Twas a famous affair and it won me,
With its titter and tinsel and
tune,
For it carried me back to the
jungle

And the monkey-dance
under the moon.

Then I mingled with other
diversions.

I learned how to paint
and to ride;
I cut a great figure at polo

The science of golfing
I tried.





As a wheelman I soon became famous
And made a great score on the track—
I was known as the king of the scorchers,
With the typical bicycle back.

Then a girl who was youthful and silly
Made love to me just for a lark,
And came with an elegant turnout

And took me to drive in the park.



And I took her out boating next
morning,

For the face of my charmer
was fair;
It carried me back to the jungle

To the flow'rs that were
blossoming there.





But soon, in the midst of my
pleasure,
In the glow of a roseate
dream,
The boat struck a rock and
tipped over
And tumbled us both in the
stream.

Then, ho, for the skill of the jungle!
The deftness of foot and of hand!
For I hung from a limb and I saved
her
And drew her at last to the
strand.





And then to her home I went proudly
To claim the fair maid for my
own,
But her father demanded a title,
And hardened his heart like a
stone.

And now came the death of my patron,
That left me alone in the strife,
And yearning once more for the jungle,
I turned to political life.



PART FOURTH.

THE RETURN PATH.

Then I studied a week to gain knowledge,
And waded through volumes of stuff,
And I found that the only requirements
Were cunning and blarney and bluff.

And these I had brought from the jungle
—
Inherited straight from my race—
With a gift for political music
And a truly political face.





Thus feeling at home in my labors,
My plan was successful, of
course,
And when they came round with
appointments

They gave me a job on "the
force."

And such was my skill as a
roundsman,
And talent in keeping the
peace,
That I rose in a year to be
Captain,
And then to be Chief of
Police!





And then, as my years were
advancing,

So great was their honor
and trust,
That they twined me a chaplet of
laurel
And sculptured in marble
my bust.





Yet often I dreamed of the jungle—
 Its song and the rustle of wing—
And sometimes still talked in my
 slumber
 With Tusky, our elephant king.

When, lo, my political party,
 That now was in power and supreme,
Conferred a most noble appointment
 That realized all of my dream.



For they made me their African envoy,
And soon I went sailing again,
To meet my old playmates and tell
them

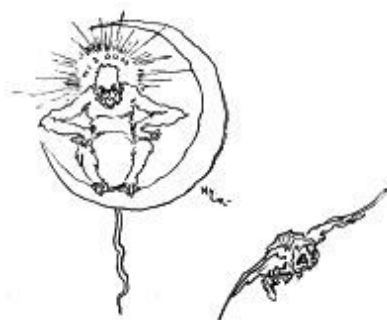
The ways and the customs of
men.

To calm the dusk native, and gather
My people in sun-haunted
nooks
To tell them my story, and teach
them
The wisdom that cometh of
books;



The words and the ways of *their fathers*,
And deliver my race from its ban,
For man did not spring from the monkey,
But monkey *descended from man*!





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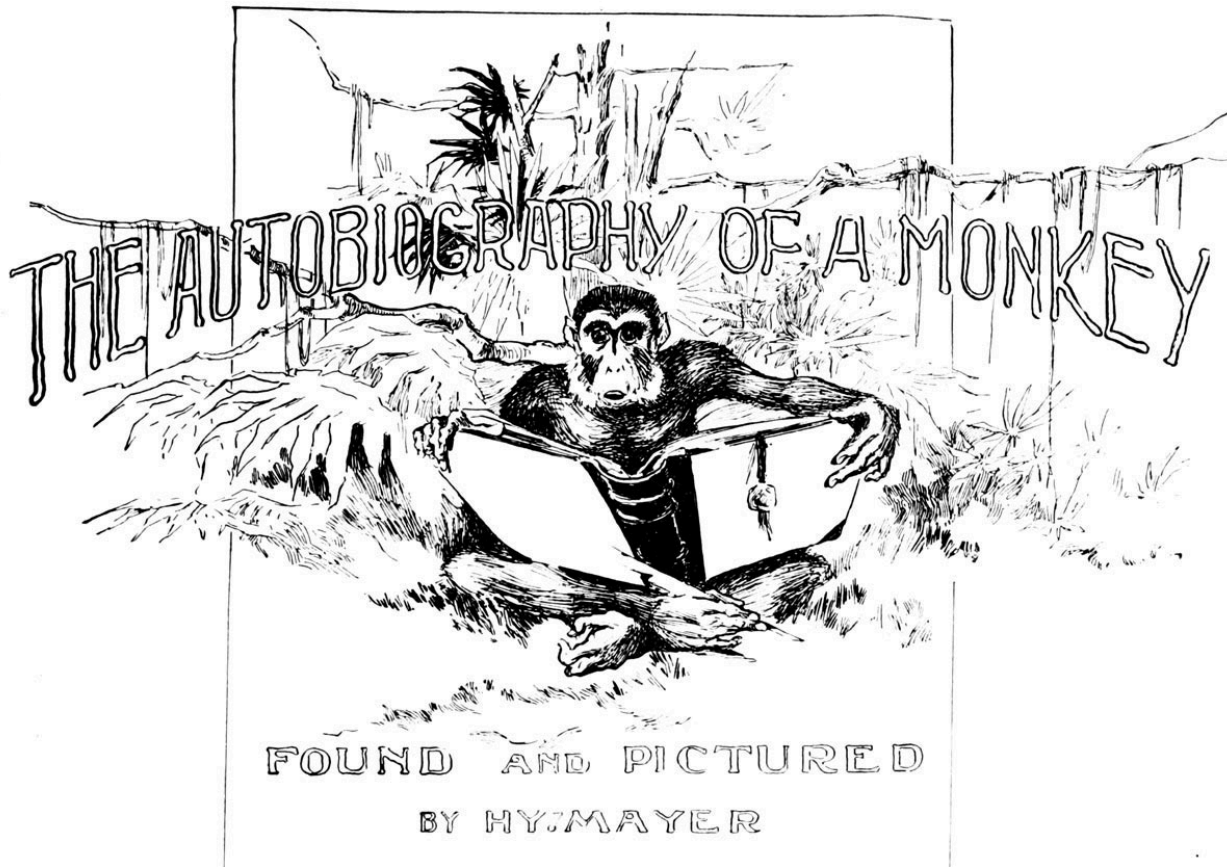
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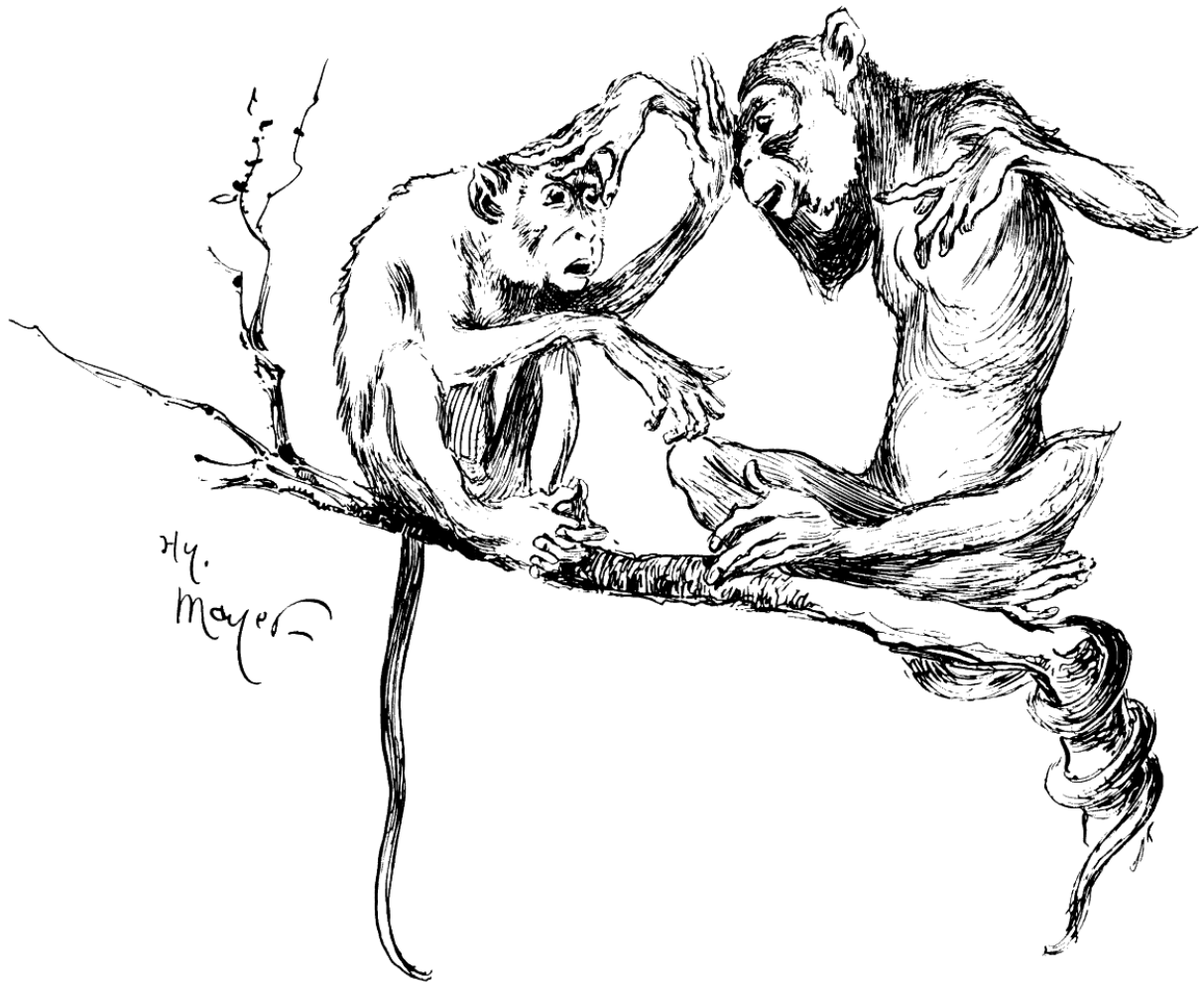
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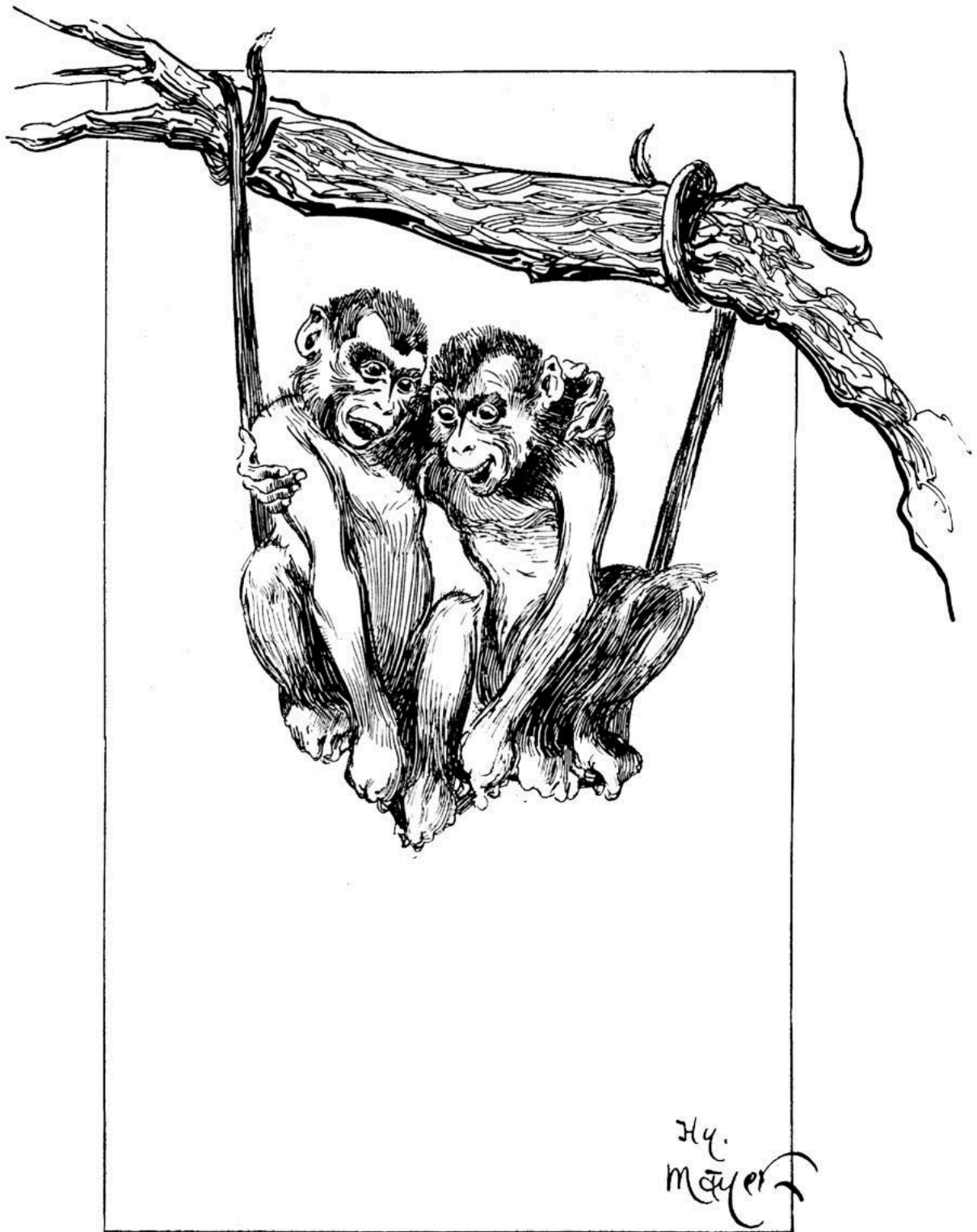
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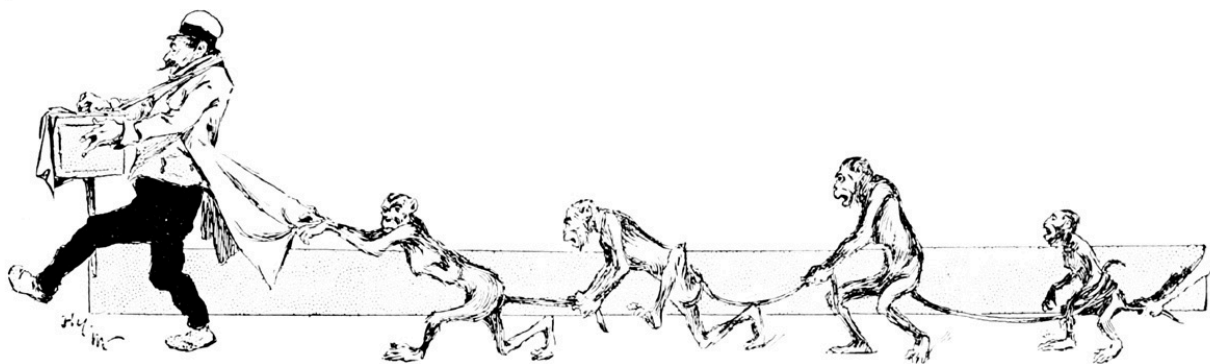
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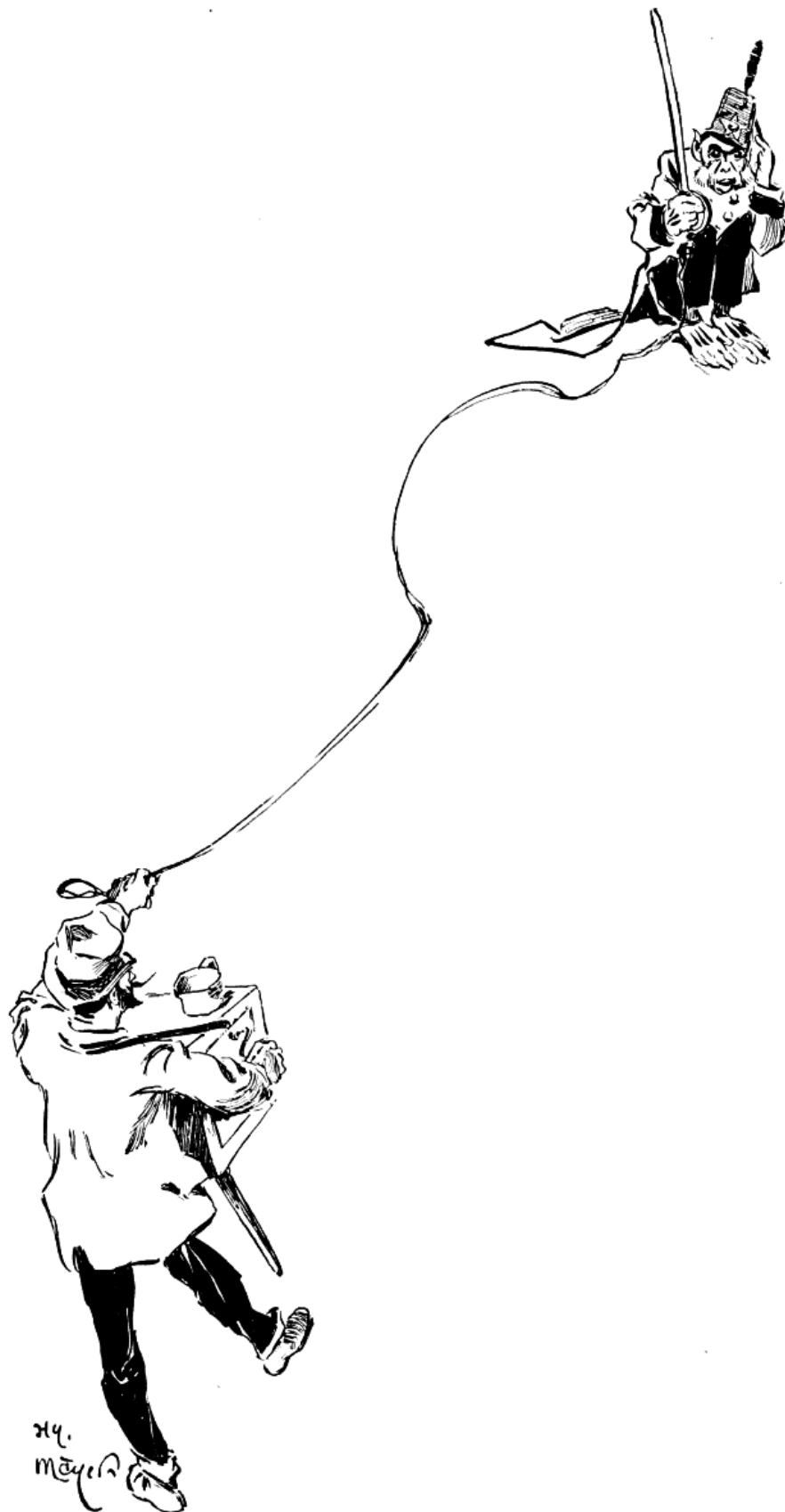
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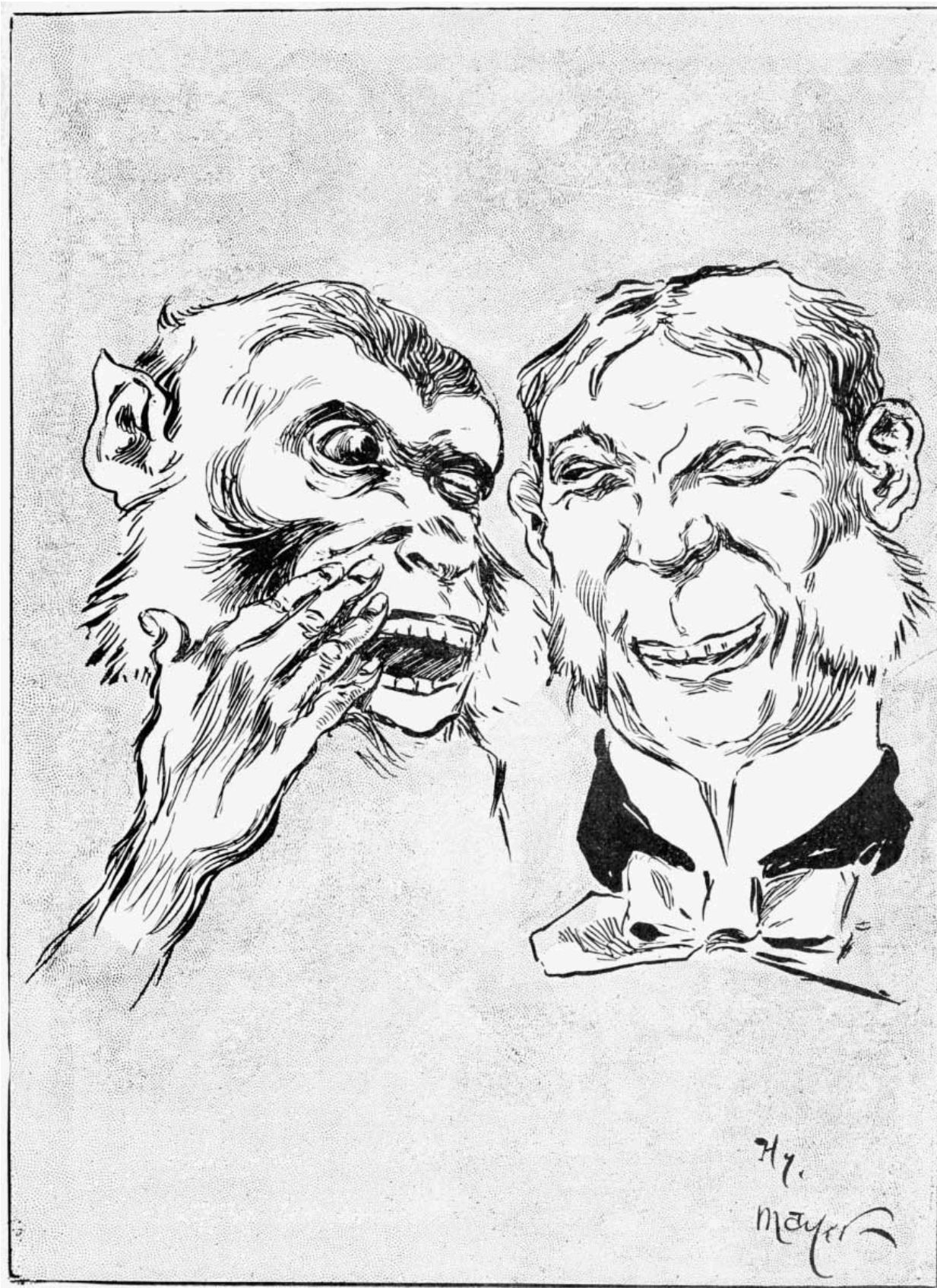
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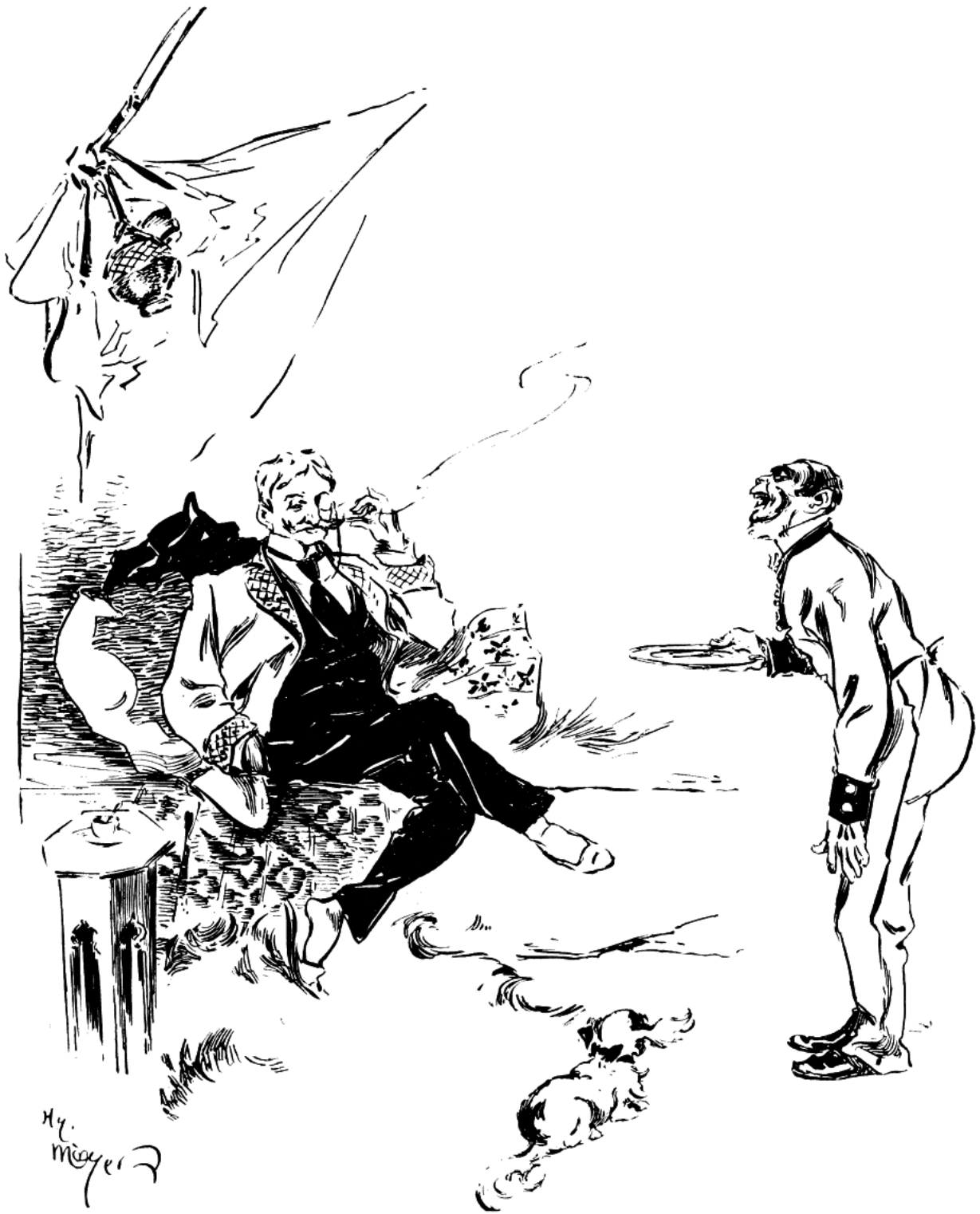
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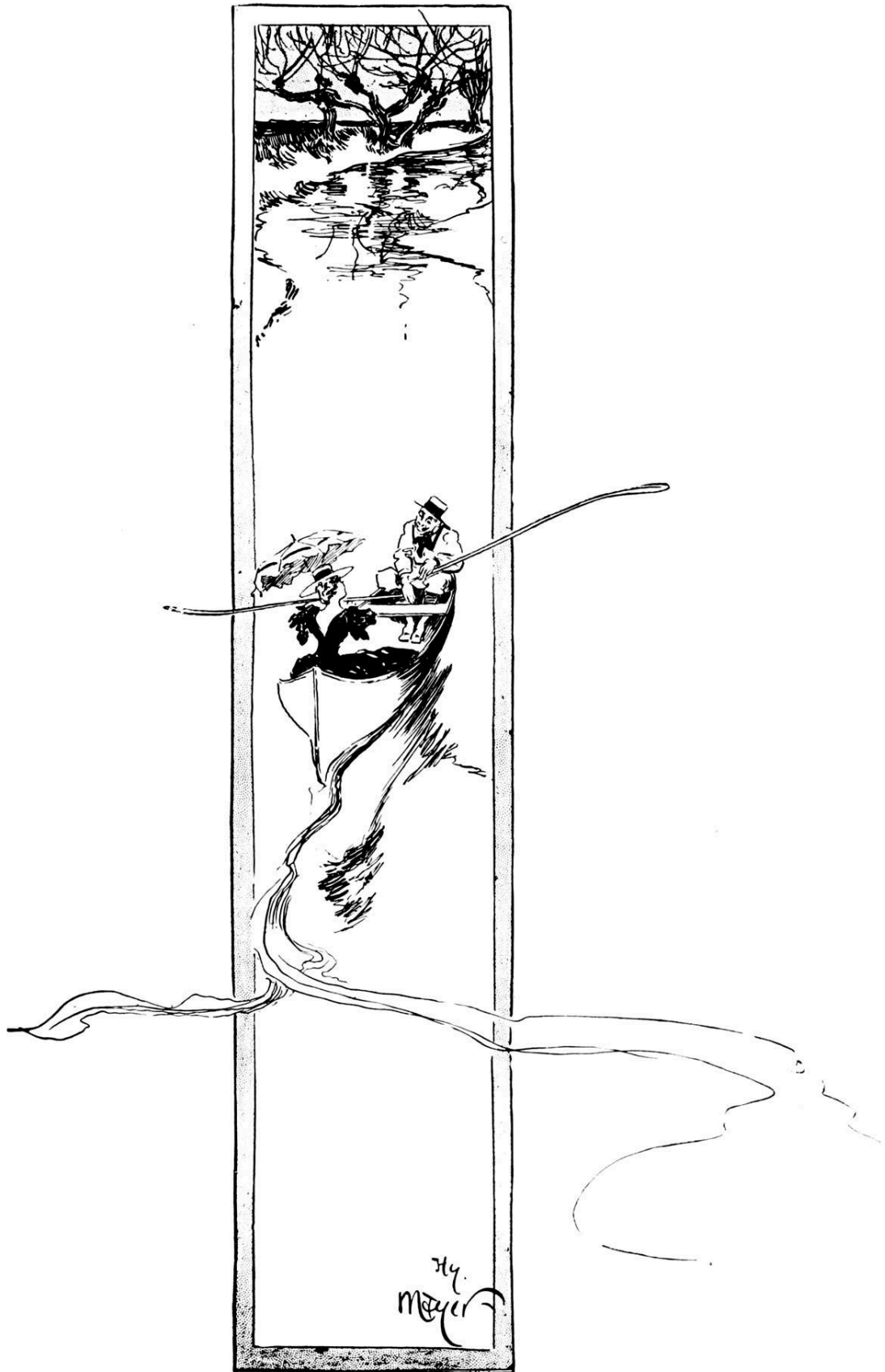
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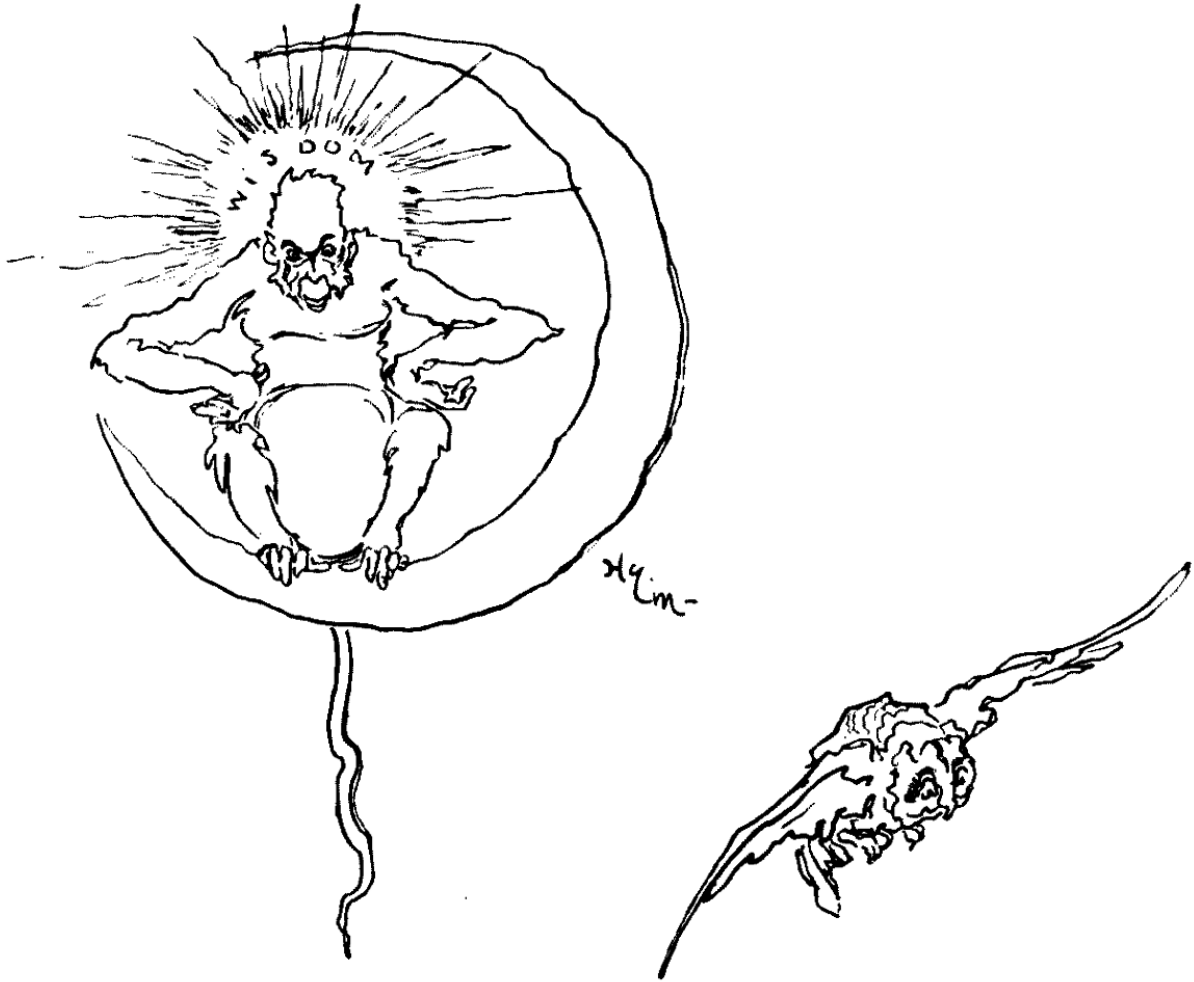
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